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General Comment

Dear Office of Science and Technology Policy (OSTP) and NITRD NCO,

I appreciate the opportunity to provide input on the development of the AI Action Plan, as directed by Executive Order 14179. As a student of AI Policy and Management at Purdue University, I recognize the importance of maintaining U.S. leadership in AI innovation. However, I urge policymakers to prioritize consumer protection, transparency, and ethical governance rather than simply reducing regulatory oversight.

While deregulation can foster rapid AI advancement, a lack of safeguards exposes consumers to risks such as discrimination, misinformation, fraud, and privacy violations. The revocation of the Biden-Harris AI Executive Order 14110 removes critical consumer protections, particularly in ensuring AI models are explainable, accountable, and safe for deployment. It is essential to establish clear liability and accountability structures for AI developers and deployers, ensuring consumers have recourse in cases of AI-induced harm. Additionally, mandatory risk assessments should be required for high-impact AI applications, such as financial services, hiring, healthcare, and law enforcement.

AI systems inherently reflect the biases present in their training data. Without proper governance, oversight, and transparency, we risk embedding structural discrimination and reinforcing societal inequalities. Moreover, the push for exponential AI development without corresponding safeguards increases the likelihood of biased decision-making in areas like hiring, lending, criminal justice, and access to government services. To mitigate these risks, AI decision-making must be auditable, with mechanisms in place to detect and correct biases. Diverse and representative training datasets should be mandated to minimize systemic discrimination, and third-party AI audits should be encouraged to ensure transparency and compliance with fairness standards.

Additionally, AI's ability to process and analyze massive datasets poses significant privacy risks. The elimination of so-called "burdensome" regulations must not come at the cost of weakened privacy rights. AI's rapid expansion into surveillance, deepfake technology, and autonomous decision-making raises serious ethical concerns that cannot be ignored. To address this, stronger data privacy protections must be implemented to prevent AI systems from exploiting personal data without informed consent. Ethical AI impact assessments should be required before deploying AI in public sector or critical infrastructure applications, and a government advisory board on AI ethics should be established to guide responsible deployment.

AI is evolving at an exponential pace, and the government traditionally moves much slower in policymaking. While accelerating AI leadership is essential, hasty deregulation can lead to long-term unintended consequences. The U.S. should pursue smart, adaptive AI policies that allow for agility without sacrificing oversight. A federal AI oversight task force should be created with the authority to adapt regulations in real time as the technology evolves. Public-private collaboration should be promoted to ensure responsible AI development while maintaining global competitiveness, and AI policy should align with international best practices to avoid regulatory fragmentation.

AI's potential to drive innovation, economic growth, and societal progress is undeniable. However, reducing regulatory oversight without ensuring strong governance, transparency, and ethical safeguards could lead to harmful, biased, and privacy-invading AI deployments. The AI Action Plan should reflect a balanced approach, ensuring the U.S. leads in AI responsibly, ethically, and with the public's best interests in mind. Thank you for considering this input. I look forward to seeing how the AI Action Plan develops to protect consumers, enhance AI accountability, and promote responsible innovation.

Sincerely,
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